

Complete Coaching Toolkit

GROW + Advanced Models (OSCAR, CLEAR, Solution-Focused)

Four coaching model guides, a 200+ question bank, session planning tools, client intake materials, and a progress measurement framework.

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Part 1

Four Coaching Model Guides

GROW

The most widely used coaching model, moving from a clear goal through honest assessment of the current situation to generating options and committing to action.

Stage	Purpose
Goal	Establish what the client actually wants to achieve, specific enough to know when it's been reached
Reality	Explore the current situation honestly, including what's been tried already and what's genuinely in the way
Options	Generate multiple possible paths forward before evaluating any of them
Will (Way Forward)	Convert the preferred option into a specific, committed action with real accountability

OSCAR

A GROW variant that separates situation from choices more explicitly and builds review into the structure itself, rather than treating it as an afterthought.

Stage	Purpose
Outcome	Define the desired result, often at both the session level and the broader engagement level
Situation	Understand the current reality, focusing on what's actually happening rather than the story about it
Choices/Consequences	Surface the realistic options available and think through their likely consequences
Actions	Commit to specific next steps arising from the chosen option
Review	Build in an explicit checkpoint to assess what actually happened, not just what was planned

CLEAR

Developed by Peter Hawkins, CLEAR places more explicit weight on the coaching relationship itself (Contract) and on genuine listening before any exploration begins.

Stage	Purpose
Contract	Explicitly agree what this session (and the engagement) is for, and what a good outcome looks like
Listen	Give full attention to understanding the client's situation before moving to explore it further
Explore	Help the client examine the situation from multiple angles, surfacing what they hadn't consciously noticed
Action	Agree specific, committed next steps
Review	Reflect on what emerged in the session itself, not just on the plan going forward

Solution-Focused Coaching

Rooted in solution-focused brief therapy principles, this approach deliberately spends less time analyzing the problem and more time building a vivid picture of the preferred future and the exceptions where things already go better.

Technique	Purpose
Miracle Question	Helps the client vividly imagine a future where the problem is already resolved, surfacing what actually matters to them
Scaling Questions	Turns abstract progress into a concrete number, making small movement visible and discussable
Exception-Finding	Identifies times the problem was less present or absent entirely, revealing resources the client already has
Coping Questions	Surfaces the client's existing resilience, especially useful when things feel stuck or bleak
Preferred Future	Builds a detailed, sensory picture of what the client actually wants, not just the absence of the problem

Part 2

Question Bank (200+ Questions)

How to Use This Bank

These are prompts to have ready, not a script to work through in order. A good coaching question follows what the client just said far more than it follows a list — use this bank to expand your range, not to replace listening.

GROW

Goal

- What would you like to achieve by the end of this conversation?
- If we were wildly successful today, what would be different?
- What does this goal actually look like when it's achieved — what would you see, hear, or notice?
- How does this goal connect to what matters most to you right now?
- Is this a goal you can genuinely influence, or does it depend heavily on someone else's actions?
- What would make this goal a stretch, without making it unrealistic?
- By when would you like to have made real progress on this?
- What's the smallest version of success here, and what's the most ambitious version?
- Whose goal is this — yours, or one you've inherited from someone else's expectations?
- What will achieving this actually change in your day-to-day experience?
- How will you know, concretely, that you've reached this goal?
- What's underneath this goal — what deeper need or value does it actually serve?
- If you could only focus on one part of this goal, which part would matter most?
- What's your honest confidence level that this goal is achievable, and what would raise it?
- How would achieving this goal affect the other priorities in your life right now?

Reality

- What's actually happening right now, as objectively as you can describe it?
- What have you already tried, and what happened when you did?
- What's working, even partially, that's worth building on?
- What's genuinely in your control here, and what isn't?
- Who else is affected by this situation, and how do they see it?
- What assumptions are you making about this situation that might not actually be true?
- On a scale of 1 to 10, how would you rate where things stand right now?
- What haven't you said yet that might be relevant here?
- What's the cost of things staying exactly as they are?
- What would someone who knows you well say is really going on here?
- What have you been avoiding looking at directly in this situation?
- What resources — time, support, skills — do you actually have available right now?
- How long has this situation been building, and what's changed recently?
- What's different about the times this goes well versus the times it doesn't?

- What don't you know yet that would help you understand this situation better?

Options

- What options can you see, even ones that seem unrealistic at first?
- What would you do if you knew you couldn't fail?
- What would you advise a friend to do in exactly this situation?
- What haven't you considered yet, even if it seems unlikely?
- What's the boldest option available to you here?
- What's the smallest possible step you could take?
- If resources weren't a constraint, what would you do?
- What would doing nothing different actually cost you?
- Which of these options excites you, even a little, and which drain you just thinking about them?
- What would it look like to combine two of these options together?
- Who could help you with this, that you haven't yet asked?
- What's an option you've dismissed too quickly, and why?
- What would the most confident version of yourself do here?
- If this option didn't work, what would your backup be?
- What option have you been avoiding because it feels uncomfortable, not because it's wrong?

Will (Way Forward)

- Which option will you actually commit to moving forward with?
- What's the very first step, and when exactly will you take it?
- On a scale of 1 to 10, how committed are you to this action right now?
- What might get in the way of you following through, and how will you handle it?
- Who will you tell about this commitment, to build in some accountability?
- What support do you need to actually follow through on this?
- How will you know if this action is working, and by when will you check?
- What would make you abandon this plan, and is that a real risk or just anxiety talking?
- If your commitment level isn't a 9 or 10, what would need to change to get it there?
- What's one thing you could do in the next 24 hours to build momentum?
- How will you celebrate or acknowledge it when you follow through?
- What will you do differently if the first attempt doesn't go as planned?
- Who is depending on you to follow through here, even indirectly?
- What does success on this specific action look like, concretely?
- When shall we check in on how this went?

OSCAR

Outcome

- What outcome are you hoping for from our work together overall?
- What would a great outcome from today's session specifically look like?
- How will you know this engagement has been worthwhile?
- What's the difference between an acceptable outcome and an exceptional one here?
- What outcome would surprise you, in a good way?
- Whose definition of success matters most here — yours, or someone else's?
- If we achieve this outcome, what becomes possible that isn't possible now?
- What would make this outcome feel like a genuine win, not just a checked box?
- How does this outcome connect to your longer-term direction?
- What's the real cost if this outcome isn't achieved?
- What time frame makes sense for this outcome to be realistic?

Situation

- Talk me through the situation as it actually stands today.
- What's the history behind how this situation developed?
- Who are the key people involved, and what's their view of it?
- What have you noticed about your own role in this situation?
- What's the piece of this situation that feels hardest to talk about?
- What's actually true here, separate from your interpretation of it?
- What's changed recently that's relevant to this situation?
- What patterns do you notice when you look at this situation over time?
- What would an outside observer notice about this situation that you might be too close to see?
- What's the emotional undercurrent in this situation, beyond the practical facts?
- What haven't you fully acknowledged yet about how this situation affects you?

Choices/Consequences

- What choices do you actually have available to you here?
- What are the likely consequences, positive and negative, of each choice?
- Which choice aligns most with your actual values, not just what seems easiest?
- What choice are you most afraid to make, and why?
- If you made this choice, what would you need to accept as a trade-off?
- What choice would you make if you weren't worried about anyone else's reaction?
- What's the reversible choice here, versus the one you can't easily undo?
- What would need to be true for the riskiest choice to actually be the right one?
- How do these choices differ in their short-term versus long-term consequences?

- What choice have you been putting off making, even to yourself?
- If you ranked these choices by how much regret you'd feel avoiding each one, what's the order?

Actions

- What specific action follows from the choice you've made?
- What's the very next physical step, not just the general direction?
- By when will you take this action?
- What needs to happen before you can take this action?
- What would make this action easier to actually start?
- Who needs to know about this action before you take it?
- What's the minimum viable version of this action, if the full version feels too big right now?
- What could you do today, even something small, to move this forward?
- How will you hold yourself accountable for this action?
- What resources do you need to gather before taking this action?
- What's your backup plan if this specific action doesn't produce the result you expect?

Review

- Looking back, what actually happened compared to what you expected?
- What worked better than you thought it would?
- What was harder than you anticipated, and why?
- What did you learn about yourself through taking this action?
- What would you do differently if you were starting this again?
- What's the next logical step, now that you've seen the result of this one?
- How has your view of the original situation shifted since taking action?
- What are you proud of in how you handled this?
- What support turned out to matter most, in hindsight?
- What would you tell someone else facing a similar situation, based on what you now know?
- Is the original outcome still the right one to aim for, or has that shifted too?

CLEAR

Contract

- What would make today's conversation genuinely useful for you?
- What are you hoping to walk away with by the end of this session?
- How much time do we realistically have, and how do you want to use it?
- What's off the table for discussion today, if anything?
- How will we know together that this session has gone well?
- What do you need from me as your coach in this conversation?
- Is there anything about how we've worked together that you'd like to adjust?
- What's the single most important thing to get to today, if we run short on time?
- What would make this feel like a safe space to be fully honest?
- How do you want me to challenge you, if I see something worth challenging?
- What's changed since we last agreed on what we're working on together?

Listen

- Tell me more about that.
- What's the feeling underneath what you just described?
- What are you not saying that might be important?
- Say more about what that was like for you.
- What stands out to you most about what you just shared?
- What's the version of this you haven't said out loud yet?
- How does it feel to hear yourself describe it that way?
- What am I hearing that you might not have noticed you were saying?
- Where do you feel that in your body as you talk about it?
- What's true about this that's hard to admit, even to yourself?
- What would you add if you knew I wouldn't judge any part of it?

Explore

- What other ways could you look at this situation?
- What would someone who disagreed with you say about this?
- What's a perspective on this you haven't fully considered?
- How might this look different in six months, looking back?
- What's the story you're telling yourself about this, and is it the only possible story?
- What would you notice if you stepped outside this situation entirely?
- What pattern does this remind you of from elsewhere in your life?
- What's the question underneath the question you're actually asking?
- What would change if you assumed the best, rather than the worst, about the other people involved?

- What's a version of this situation where you're not the one at fault, or the one responsible for fixing it?
- What haven't we explored yet that feels important?

Action

- Given everything we've explored, what feels like the right next step?
- What specifically will you do, and by when?
- What's the very first move, even a small one?
- What might stop you from following through, and how will you handle that?
- Who else needs to be part of this action?
- What would make this action feel achievable rather than overwhelming?
- How confident do you feel about actually doing this?
- What do you need in place before you can take this step?
- What's the cost of not taking this action?
- How will this action move you toward what you said you wanted at the start?
- What's one thing you could do right after this session ends?

Review

- What's landed for you most from today's conversation?
- What are you taking away that you didn't have coming in?
- How does this connect to what you said you wanted from today?
- What was useful about how we worked through this today?
- What would you want to explore further next time?
- What are you noticing about yourself as this conversation closes?
- How ready do you feel to act on what we discussed?
- What's still unresolved that we should return to?
- What feedback do you have for me about today's session?
- What's the headline of today's conversation, in one sentence?
- What do you want to remember from today a week from now?

Solution-Focused

Miracle Question

- Suppose you went to sleep tonight and while you were sleeping, a miracle happened and this problem was solved. What would you notice first that told you something had changed?
- If this challenge disappeared overnight, what would you be doing differently tomorrow morning?
- What would other people notice about you if this were already resolved?
- What's the first small sign that would tell you things were moving in the right direction?
- If you woke up and this was no longer a problem, what would you stop worrying about?
- What would a typical day look like if this issue were fully behind you?
- Who would notice the change first, and what would they say?
- What would you be doing with the time and energy this problem currently takes up?
- If this were resolved, what would you want to say to yourself looking back on this period?
- What's the very first thing that would feel different in your body if this were solved?
- What would change about how you start your day if this were no longer weighing on you?
- If a photo were taken of your life after this miracle, what would be in the frame?

Scaling Questions

- On a scale of 1 to 10, where are you today on this issue?
- What's making it a [number] and not one point lower?
- What would need to happen to move just one point higher?
- What was different about a time you were one point higher than you are now?
- Where would you like to be on this scale, realistically, in one month?
- What number would your closest colleague or friend give you, and would that surprise you?
- What's the smallest sign that would tell you you'd moved half a point?
- If you're at a 4 today, what does a 5 actually look like in practice?
- What's stopping this from being a 1, even on a hard day?
- How confident are you, from 1 to 10, that you can move up this scale?
- What would it take to stay at this number rather than slipping backward?
- If today is a 6, what was yesterday, and what changed?

Exception-Finding

- Tell me about a time recently when this problem was less present, even slightly.
- What was different about that time?
- What were you doing differently when things went a little better?
- Who else was involved during that better moment, and what did they do?
- What made that exception possible, even if it was brief?
- How did you personally contribute to that better outcome?
- What would it take to make that exception happen more often?

- Was there a time this problem could have shown up but didn't? What was different?
- What did you notice about yourself during that exception that you'd want to repeat?
- What conditions seem to make the exception more likely to happen again?
- If that exception happened once, what does that tell you about what's possible?
- What's the smallest version of that exception you could try to recreate this week?

Coping Questions

- Given how difficult this has been, how have you managed to keep going?
- What have you been doing to stop this from getting even worse?
- Where has your resilience come from during this period?
- What's helped you get through days when this has felt hardest?
- What does it say about you that you're still here, working on this?
- Who or what has supported you most through this, even in small ways?
- What have you learned about your own strength through dealing with this?
- What's one thing you've done recently that you're quietly proud of, given the circumstances?
- How have you managed to keep functioning while carrying this?
- What's kept you from giving up on this entirely?
- What internal resource have you drawn on that you didn't know you had?
- What would you tell someone else going through exactly what you're going through?

Preferred Future

- What does your preferred future actually look like, in specific detail?
- If things went as well as they possibly could, what would that mean for you day to day?
- What would you be spending more time doing in that preferred future?
- What would you have let go of by the time you reach that preferred future?
- Who would be part of that preferred future with you?
- What would you be proud of having built by then?
- What's the very next chapter, before you get to the fully preferred future?
- What would need to be true about you, not just your circumstances, in that future?
- How would you describe that future to someone who's never heard about your current situation?
- What's one detail of that preferred future you haven't said out loud yet?
- What would it feel like to actually be living that future, right now, for just a moment?
- What's the smallest piece of that preferred future you could start building today?

Part 3

Session Planning Tools

Session Structure Template

Segment	Approx. Time	Purpose
Pre-Session Prep	Before the session	Review previous session notes, committed actions, and any pattern worth raising
Opening & Contracting	5 min	Agree what would make this specific session useful (see CLEAR's Contract stage)
Core Coaching Conversation	35-40 min	Apply the chosen model — don't force every stage if the conversation naturally needs more time in one area
Committing to Action	10 min	Land on a specific, time-bound commitment, not just a general intention
Closing & Review	5 min	Reflect on what emerged in the session itself and confirm the next check-in point

Choosing a Model for the Session

- GROW or OSCAR when the client has a specific, fairly bounded goal to work through
- CLEAR when the coaching relationship itself, or genuinely being heard, matters as much as reaching an action
- Solution-focused techniques when the client feels stuck, overwhelmed, or is struggling to see any way forward
- It's entirely reasonable to blend techniques from more than one model within a single session

Session Notes Template

Field	Notes
Date	
Model(s) used	
Key themes that emerged	
Committed actions	
Follow-up needed before next session	

Part 4

Client Intake Materials

New Client Intake Form

Field	Details
Name	[Client name]
What brings you to coaching right now?	[Open response]
What would make this coaching engagement worthwhile to you?	[Open response]
Have you worked with a coach before? What worked, or didn't?	[Open response]
Preferred session frequency	[Weekly / Biweekly / Monthly]
Preferred communication style	[Direct and challenging / Gentle and exploratory / A mix, depending on topic]

Coaching Agreement Essentials

- Confidentiality — what stays between coach and client, and any limits to that (e.g. safety concerns)
- Session logistics — frequency, length, cancellation policy
- Roles — coaching is not therapy, mentoring, or consulting; be explicit about which this is and isn't
- Boundaries for contact between sessions, if any

If a client's stated concerns suggest they may need clinical mental health support rather than coaching, it's appropriate to say so directly and refer them to a qualified professional — coaching is not a substitute for therapy.

Part 5

Progress Measurement Framework

Measuring Progress

Coaching progress is often qualitative, but that doesn't mean it can't be tracked consistently — a simple, repeated structure makes progress visible to both coach and client over time.

Method	How It Works	Cadence
Scaling check-in	Ask the client to rate progress on their primary goal, 1-10, at the start of each session	Every session
Committed-action follow-through	Track what percentage of committed actions were actually completed between sessions	Every session
Qualitative markers	Note specific, observable changes the client or others have noticed, in their own words	Every session
Formal progress review	A dedicated session reviewing progress against the original goals from intake	Every 4-6 sessions

Progress Review Template

Original Goal	Progress Rating (1-10)	What's Changed	What's Still Needed

A stalled scaling number across several sessions is itself useful data — it's worth raising directly with the client rather than continuing the same approach and hoping the number moves on its own.